

Fly GACA — Go-to-Market: Flight Schools (B2B-First)

SECTION 07-gtm TYPE document STATUS **active** OWNER Founder UPDATED 2026-08-19

Status: plan, not built · **Maps to:** `roadmap.md` Phase 5, `office/spec-instructor-dashboard.md`
Prepared: 2026-05-30 · **Companion:** `strategy-competitive-teardown.md`

The roadmap puts Schools in Phase 5, after a long consumer build and behind the legal entity. This document argues for the opposite sequencing — **B2B before consumer-paid** — and lays out the motion to land the first academies. The thesis from the competitive teardown: this market is small enough to be **winner-take-most, and it is won through institutions, not SEO**.

Not legal advice. Live invoicing depends on the legal entity (`phase0.md` PO-3) and ZATCA onboarding (`roadmap.md` Phase 5). A pilot can run on a manual contract before that lands.

1. Why B2B-first beats consumer-first here

	Consumer freemium (current plan)	B2B-first (this doc)
Buyer count to meaningful revenue	hundreds of individuals at SAR 79/mo	3–5 institutions on annual packages of SAR 12,000–72,000
Revenue per close	~SAR 79/mo (SAR 649/yr), high churn	one annual package, 25–100+ seats , low churn
Engagement data for the AI	scattered, self-selected	captive cohorts generating dense usage data
Defensibility	none — features are cloneable	switching cost + reference logo per school
Gate	needs full payroll + payments	a contract + a roster + a dashboard

The arithmetic is the argument: one Cohort package (SAR 12,000/yr) equals **19 Pro annual subscriptions** at SAR 649 — sold once, to one buyer, with one invoice, against nineteen separate consumer acquisitions that each churn on their own schedule.

A signed academy delivers three compounding assets at once: revenue, a reference logo that makes the next school trivial, and the cohort data that makes Captain Adel and the exam-readiness analytics measurably better than any self-serve competitor's.

2. Target segments (Saudi, in priority order)

1. **GACA-approved ATOs / flight academies** — the core. Cadets sit GACA written exams; the school carries the pass-rate risk. This is the package buyer.
2. **Aviation faculties / technical colleges** running ground school.
3. **Type-rating & conversion shops** serving foreign pilots entering the Kingdom — these feed the Conversion Prep Pack line directly.
4. **Corporate / GA flight departments** with recurrency and currency-tracking needs.

Maintain the live prospect list in a private CRM, not in-repo — it is personal/commercial data and the repo is public. This doc holds the *motion*, not the contacts.

3. The offer

Anchored on the price card in [03-finance/monetization.md](#). Fly GACA for Schools sells **annual packages, not seats**. The school buys a capacity band for a year; it does not buy, count or negotiate individual seats.

Package	Price (SAR, VAT-incl.)	Capacity	Term	How it's bought
Cohort	12,000 / yr	up to 25 seats	one 90-day intake	self-serve checkout, published price
Academy	39,000 / yr	up to 100 seats	rolling 12 months	contact sales
Institution	from 72,000	100+ seats, SSO	annual	contact sales

- **Admin dashboard included** at every tier — cohort exam-readiness, per-cadet progress, who's falling behind (the genuine instructor tool, built per [spec-instructor-dashboard.md](#)).
- Annual contract; ZATCA-compliant invoicing once the entity is live.
- **Published prices are an acquisition edge.** Almost every flight-school software vendor is quote-only; a school can price us in ten seconds without a sales call. Do not undercut the card in a first conversation — the price is the credibility.

Why this beats the per-seat card it replaces. A seat-band quote invited a negotiation on every line — how many cadets, which band, what happens at 24 seats — and it priced our smallest buyer highest. A package moves the conversation from *unit price* to *fit*: which band, and when does the intake start. The implied per-seat economics are strong enough to hold their own in that conversation if a Head of Training raises them — **480/seat/yr at Cohort, ~390 at Academy** — against 25 cadets each buying a foreign course at SAR 930–1,120 (SAR 23k+).

The wedge in the pitch: built on **GACAR** (not FAA), every quiz answer cited to the exact Part, the only platform pairing Saudi regulation with real accident lessons, and bilingual. No FAA-based incumbent (Gleim, Sporty's, King) can say any of that.

4. The motion (no entity required to start)

1. **Build the demo asset** — a one-page school deck + a live dashboard walkthrough on seeded demo data. Lead with cohort readiness and the cited-explanation wedge.
2. **Warm intros** to 8–10 academies; book pilot conversations.
3. **Land 1–2 pilot cohorts** on a manual letter of agreement (no payment gateway needed yet) — a free 14-day pilot sized inside the Cohort cap, in exchange for usage and a testimonial.
4. **Instrument and report** — weekly cohort readiness back to the instructor; this report *is* the retention mechanism and the renewal case.
5. **Convert pilots to a paid Cohort package** once the entity + ZATCA are live; use the references to open the Academy-sized schools.

Open commercial decision. The retired price card carried a founding-partner rate (SAR 199/seat flat for the first 2–3 schools). Package pricing has no per-seat lever to discount, so the reference-logo concession has to be re-expressed — a percentage off the first annual package, a free first intake, or a capacity bump (Cohort price at Academy capacity). **Not yet decided; do not quote a founding rate until it is.** See `07-gtm/b2b-pipeline.md`.

5. What has to be built (and what doesn't yet)

Build now (not gated by the entity):

- The instructor/admin dashboard — `spec-instructor-dashboard.md` (multi-tenant model + rules).
- The school deck and seeded demo cohort.
- A "talk to sales" enquiry path on `/schools` for Academy and Institution (Cohort is the only self-serve tier).
- Seat provisioning is already live: `POST /api/org/:orgId/provision-seats` writes the roster to the `org_seats` table (Cloud SQL Postgres), capped by the org's `seat_limit` and dated to the 90-day intake window; each member then self-claims via `POST /api/grants/school-seat` on a **verified** email, which merges a `plan: 'school'` entitlement upward. No client can grant itself a seat — there is no route that writes its own plan.

Defer to the business track (gated by `phase0.md` P0-3):

- ZATCA VAT registration + Fatoora e-invoicing.
- Moyasar live (the gateway of record — mada, card, Apple Pay), which is what turns Cohort into a self-serve checkout rather than an invoice.

6. Success metric for the quarter

One signed pilot cohort and one reference-able logo beats any amount of consumer polish. That single proof point is the thing a funded competitor cannot quickly replicate — and the thing that turns the channel from open to defended.

7. The risk this closes

Per the teardown, the move to fear most is a competitor **buying the channel** — exclusive ATO prep partnerships locked before we register the entity. Landing pilot cohorts now, even unpaid, is the direct counter: it is far harder to displace an incumbent already running a school's cohort than to sign a school that has no platform yet.